

Diego Fortes

Co-Founder & Software Engineer | TypeScript & Frontend Architecture

daigof@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/fortesdiego](https://www.linkedin.com/in/fortesdiego) | github.com/daigof



Summary

Software Engineer with 16+ years of experience building web platforms, modernizing frontend architectures, and delivering full-stack SaaS products. Experienced as a startup co-founder, enterprise technical lead, open-source contributor, and senior frontend consultant. Strong focus on TypeScript, React, developer tooling, product architecture, performance, and reliable user experiences.

Key Areas of Expertise

- **Zero-to-one engineering:** Built secure, multi-tenant SaaS platforms from scratch.
- **Frontend modernization:** Migrated legacy PHP, Java, AngularJS, and CRA systems to modern React, Vite, and TypeScript architectures.
- **Technical leadership:** Led contractor teams, mentored engineers, shaped product schemas, and collaborated across English- and Spanish-speaking teams.
- **Performance and reliability:** Improved build systems, runtime performance, asset pipelines, testing, and cloud/security delivery.

Experience

HoundDog.ai | Co-Founder & Software Engineer

February 2024 - Present | San Francisco Bay Area, Remote

- Built the HoundDog.ai SaaS platform from scratch as the sole frontend developer using Remix, TypeScript, Shadcn, and Tailwind CSS.
- Implemented atomic state management with Jotai and multi-tenant authentication with PropelAuth.
- Improved core scanning infrastructure, contributing system-level enhancements to a Rust-based AST scanner.
- Extended backend capabilities by designing and building Django REST APIs for full-stack product features.

Toptal | Senior Frontend Engineer

December 2015 - Present

- Delivered senior frontend and full-stack consulting engagements for global companies through the Toptal network.
- Specialized in modern frontend infrastructure, framework migrations, developer tooling, performance improvements, and long-term maintainability.
- Selected engagements include Curology, PaidUp, iwoca, Sellr, CUPS, Listen360, PVBid, and DoubleNet Pay.

Atlas Health | Senior Frontend Engineer

August 2022 - January 2024

- Modernized the frontend build pipeline by migrating the core platform from Create React App to Vite and Vitest, reducing build and test times from minutes to seconds while removing legacy security issues.
- Led the transition to TypeScript and helped establish a type-safe codebase.
- Reworked unsafe Redux state management into a more predictable atomic architecture with Jotai.
- Improved engineering standards by configuring ESLint, Prettier, and TypeScript tooling.
- Added automated end-to-end test coverage with Cypress.
- Mentored junior engineers on React, TypeScript, frontend architecture, and code quality practices.
- Supported staff-level architecture discussions, including technical feasibility, database schema design, and user interface decisions.

Curology | Senior Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

January 2019 - August 2022

- Led the migration of the core web platform from a legacy PHP architecture to a modern React stack using Gatsby and Emotion.
- Maintained and improved client-facing applications built with React, TypeScript, and MobX.
- Built features for internal administrative tools, improving operational workflows and interface efficiency.
- Migrated Radiance UI, Curology's open-source component library, to TypeScript.
- Used Storybook to document reusable components and scalable design patterns.

Restoration Media | Senior Full-Stack Engineer

August 2017 - September 2018

- Built and launched four full-stack web applications with admin panels using Angular, Node.js, Express, and MongoDB.
- Designed a unified authentication architecture with Passport.js and Google OAuth to support single sign-on across multiple platforms.
- Built a custom frontend asset pipeline with Gulp for EJS templates and LESS compilation.
- Established backend test coverage using Mocha, Chai, Sinon, and Supertest, consistently maintaining more than 80% coverage.
- Integrated third-party services including Google DFP, AdButler, AWS S3, and SendGrid.

PaidUp - Stop Chasing Payments | Senior Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

January 2018 - July 2018

- Redesigned and modernized the core web platform by migrating the legacy stack to Vue.js.
- Built a fully responsive, mobile-first interface focused on maintainability and cross-device usability.

iwoca | Senior Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

January 2018 - February 2018

- Built a high-performance server-side rendered web platform using Gatsby, React, GraphQL, and Contentful CMS.
- Designed custom CMS data models in Contentful and structured the GraphQL schema, queries, and mutations for efficient content delivery.
- Implemented custom responsive interfaces with React and Stylus, optimizing rendering performance across device sizes.

Sellr | Senior Full-Stack Engineer, via Toptal

August 2016 - July 2017

- Maintained and improved four full-stack web applications backed by Node.js, Express, MongoDB, and MySQL.
- Redesigned two core applications with custom responsive interfaces, replacing rigid framework-driven layouts.
- Built three hybrid mobile applications with AngularJS and Ionic for iPad and mobile phone form factors.
- Extended a React-based product discovery application with advanced listing, filtering, and client-side state management.

CUPS | Full-Stack Engineer, via Toptal

March 2016 - May 2017

- Modernized the frontend architecture by migrating the platform from React 0.14 to React 15.
- Built a lightweight CMS solution with an EJS template engine backed by structured JSON content models.
- Developed Node.js and Express infrastructure, including middleware, secure routes, and REST endpoints.
- Integrated Google Maps API features for location search, spatial querying, and proximity rendering.
- Designed a telemetry and analytics tracking engine using ES6+ and Babel.

Listen360 | Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

February 2016 - December 2016

- Converted high-fidelity Photoshop designs into production web interfaces with strong visual accuracy.

- Built customized interactive UI components by extending and styling third-party jQuery plugins.
- Developed a responsive, mobile-first layout using SASS.
- Improved platform interactivity with modular JavaScript and jQuery.

PaidUp - Stop Chasing Payments | Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

April 2016 - May 2016

- Led greenfield frontend development for a new web application using AngularJS and Browserify.
- Built a responsive, mobile-first interface with Materialize CSS and LESS.
- Helped modernize the product by contributing to the migration toward Vue.js.

DoubleNet Pay | Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

2016

- Refactored a legacy web platform by modularizing Backbone.js and Handlebars components.
- Built an automated Gulp pipeline for minification, concatenation, and cache-busting.
- Converted InVision prototypes into responsive interfaces with strong visual fidelity across device sizes.

PVBid, Inc. | Frontend Engineer, via Toptal

2016

- Improved client-side runtime performance by analyzing AngularJS workflows and migrating critical interactions to lightweight JavaScript and jQuery.
- Modernized the application presentation layer with modular SASS and interactive jQuery components.

Southapps | Frontend Engineer

August 2015 - December 2015

- Built and launched a cross-platform mobile application using Ionic and AngularJS.
- Developed and styled more than 30 application screens from high-fidelity UI/UX mockups.
- Created modular SASS styles for reusable, maintainable mobile interfaces.

ExxonMobil | Project Technical Lead & Senior Web Developer

September 2011 - December 2015

- Led technical direction for two enterprise-scale initiatives: the global redesign of ExxonMobil's public-facing web presence and the migration of a Java B2B platform into an Angular single-page application.
- Directed cross-functional development teams contracted from Deloitte, maintaining code quality, delivery milestones, and architecture standards for a platform processing millions of dollars in daily transactions.
- Designed and supported global corporate web applications, including a legacy enterprise CMS migration from Documentum to Sitecore.
- Owned enterprise web infrastructure administration and integration across Akamai CDN, Google Search Appliance, and Webtrends analytics.

IBM | Web Application Engineer

2011 - 2012

- Maintained and improved an enterprise J2EE web application within IBM's global Procurement department.
- Built client-side features with vanilla JavaScript and Prototype.js to support frontend performance and cross-browser behavior.
- Implemented RESTful web services to integrate backend business logic and internal data flows.
- Wrote SQL queries and managed persistence logic for IBM DB2 databases.

Dridco, Zonaprop.com | Full-Stack Engineer

2010 - 2011

- Built and optimized features for a high-traffic e-commerce web application using Java, Spring Framework, and Hibernate.
- Modernized frontend interactions with jQuery Tools and jQuery UI.

- Wrote SQL scripts to improve data structures, indexes, and storage behavior across Oracle and SQL Server environments.
- Collaborated with product and engineering teams to deliver full-stack features across backend services and user interfaces.

Globant | Web Engineer, Contracted to EMC Corporation

2009 - 2010

- Supported global enterprise digital platforms for EMC Corporation using Documentum.
- Built data-driven layouts with XSLT, semantic HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Developed custom WordPress themes with modular CSS.
- Created accessible HTML and CSS assets for internet marketing campaigns with strong email-client compatibility.

Enexum | Web Developer

2008 - 2009

- Built accessible layouts and interactive user interfaces with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Debugged and resolved cross-browser compatibility issues across multiple web applications.
- Supported enterprise client work involving XSLT data transformations and server-side content delivery.

Education

- **UNLP, Universidad Nacional de La Plata** - Master's Degree, Computer Software Engineering, 2010 - 2011
- **Universidad Tecnologica Nacional** - Engineering Degree, Information Systems Engineering, 2003 - 2009
- **Universidad Tecnologica Nacional** - Analyst Degree, Information Systems Analyst, 2003 - 2007